

Bachelor Thesis

Fall 26/27

Who am I?

Who are YOU?

Why do we need science?

BUSINESS RATHENAU INSTITUTE SURVEY SCIENCE UTRECHT AMSTERDAM

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SATURDAY, 19 JULY 2025 - 07:45

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No middle ground: Dutch either trust science completely, or not at all

NEWS | 22 April 2026

‘Staggering’ number of people believe unproven claims about vaccines, raw milk and more

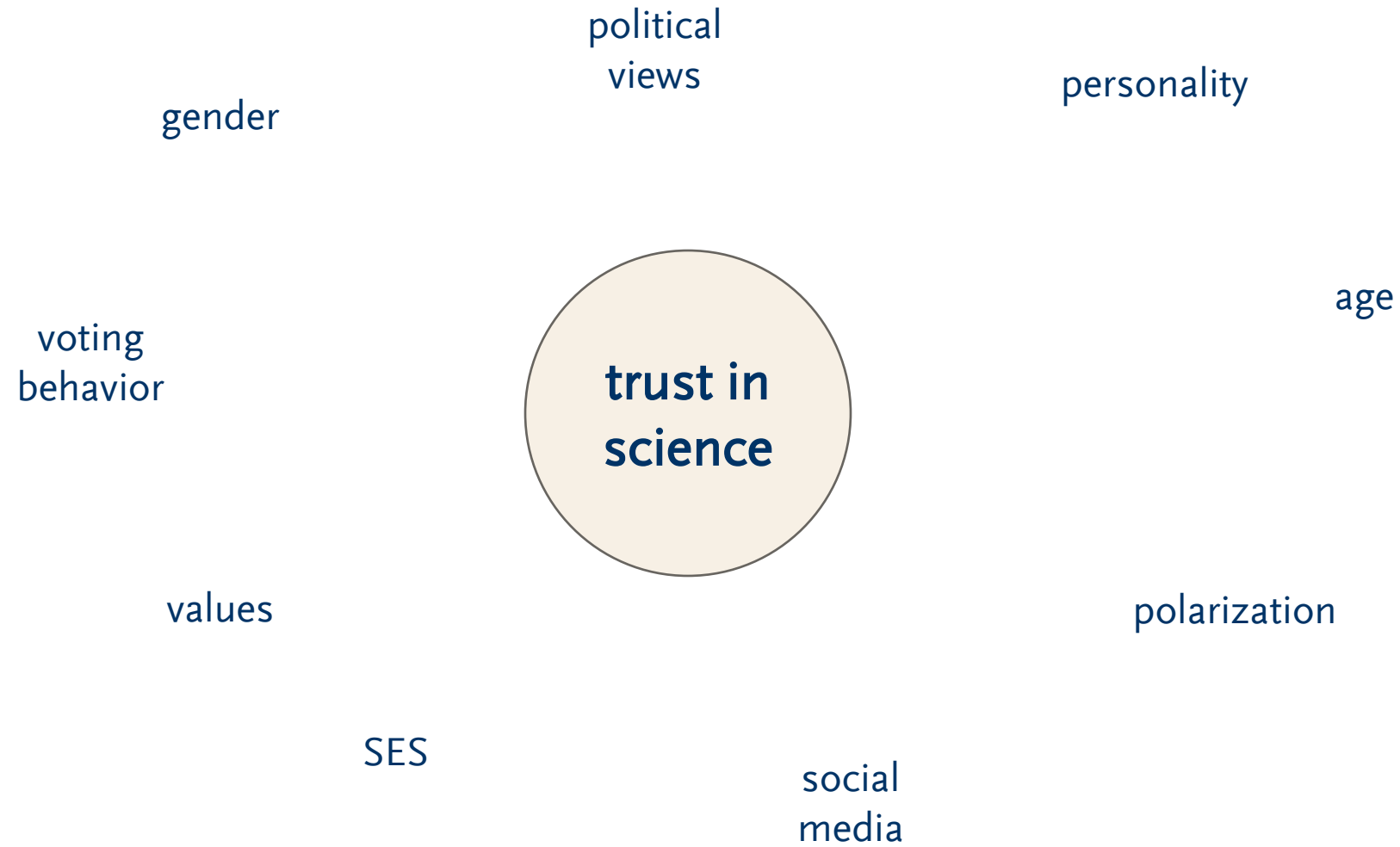
Survey results suggest a rise in questioning of scientific evidence.

Colleges and universities must show their economic value, according to the House of Representatives

Higher Education Press Office • 09 September 2026 • 11:10

From patents to spin-offs, to what extent do colleges and universities contribute to the Dutch economy? They have to map that out, according to a large majority of the House of Representatives.

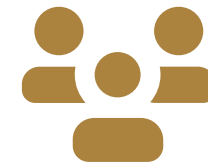
With their assault on science, Trumpists aren't just harming America – they're harming themselves



How are we going to explore this?

Data

Online data collection (~200 participants)
Validated questionnaires



Population

Depends on your data collection efforts and interests



Analyses

Depend on your research questions :)

What is a research proposal?

Doing research is a lot like building a house

- Requires a lot of planning (drawing, permits, design, ...)
- Requires teamwork (architects, builders, electricians, ...)
- Is affected by a lot of external factors (weather, fatigue, other responsibilities, ...)

A proposal is **essential** in order to account for all potential hurdles

- It is a **research plan** that simplifies and guides final work



How to write a proposal?

1. Read the literature previously shared with you.
2. Find a set of variables you are **genuinely** interested in exploring.
3. Think about the measures you can use **to research these variables**. Refer to the planned questionnaires and scales.
4. Do not plan to mix questionnaires into one variable, and do not split them up unless you have a good reason (or a published paper provided a good argument for it).
5. Formulate a research question and hypotheses with this set of variables.
6. Write all the plans up, together with all other parts of the proposal.



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DEFINITELY INCLUDED

SCIENCE-RELATED: psychological distance to science, opinions about science funding, belief in science, attitudes towards science credibility, current understanding of science

PERSONALITY-RELATED: open-minded thinking, personality traits along the big 5

BELIEF-RELATED: human values, political identity

DEMOGRAPHIC: age, gender

CAN BE INCLUDED

BELIEF-RELATED: sexist attitudes

DEMOGRAPHIC: SES

BEHAVIOR-RELATED: social media use (e.g., certain platforms – Y/N questions, time spent on social media per week – self-report), self-reported AI use...

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Important to **plan ahead**. You should not change the RQ and hypothesis after starting the research.

A hypothesis is an **educated prediction** for the research question.

It specifies **the population to which it applies, it is quantifiable, and testable**.

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You can find the detailed guidelines on the thesis website!

If you plan well...



Do you have any questions

- About the planning
- About the project
- About your next task
- About me...?

If in doubt...

- Check the website
- Check thesis guidelines
- Contact your fellow students
- Contact me

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